

The Merry Ukrainian Ploughboy

by Jeremiah Lynch, c. 1920; modified by Lew Toulmin, Jan. 2025; bass strum

Intro: G D D7 G

Well [G] I am a merry [D] ploughboy
And I ploughed the fields all [G] day
When it [D] suddenly came to my mind
That I should be [D7] goin' a[G]way.
Yes, I've always hated [D] tyrants
Since the [C] day that I was [G] born
So I'm [D] off to join the A.F.U., [Armed Forces of Ukraine]
And I'm leavin' [C] tomorrow [G] morn'

Yes, [G] some men fight for [D] silver
And some men fight for [G] gold
But the [D] A.F.U. is fighting for
The land that [D7] Putin [G] stole!

CHORUS

[Chorus]:

And we're all [G] off to [D] Kursk in a flash, in a flash [part of Russia seized by A.F.U.]
Blue and yellow shining in the [G] sun [Ukrainian flag]
Where the orcs are [D] mashed and their tanks are smashed [Russian soldiers]
By our brave old [D7] Bradley's [G] gun [US-made infantry fighting vehicle]

Well, I'll [G] leave aside me pick [D] and spade
And I'll leave aside me [G] plough
And I'll [D] bring along those drones I made,
For that's what we all [D7] need [G] now
Yes, I'll take me trusty [D] PKM [reliable Soviet/Ukrainian machine gun]
And its [C] bandoleer of [G] lead
For do [D] or die, I can but try
To avenge the [C] Ukraine's [G] dead

CHORUS

Well, I'll [G] say goodbye to [D] Anna [soft, lower strings]
She's the girl I do [G] adore
And I [D] wonder if she'll think of me
When she hears our [D7] Caesar's [G] roar [excellent French self-propelled howitzer]
And when this war [D] is over
And dear [C] old Ukraine's [G] free
I will [D] take her to the church to wed
And a soldier's [C] wife she'll [G] be

CHORUS

Yes, we'll [G] drive on south for [D] 1000 miles [NAFO Sniffing Brigade volunteer convoy of trucks]
In Nissans and HiLux [G] too
from [D] Tallinn down to our old Kiev,
to help our [D7] boys in [G] blue [A.F.U. soldiers]
Yes, our trucks will drive off [D] Ruzzians
And save [C] our wounded [G] few
Those [D] drivers and our front-line troops
Are all heroes [C] of the [G] A.F.U.!

CHORUS, then to upper right verse